

- c) where your friends were accepted. It's your first time away from home, after all, and you wouldn't want to give up your social life.
- d) the brochure. Everyone in the glossy photos looked like they were having a good time.
- e) the fact that it was the only school that accepted you.

If you picked A and you answered C or D to question 1, good for you. You're a good fit for college and you're making good use of all the perks and gifts the institution of your choice offers.

If you chose B, maybe your priority is to graduate without debt. But make sure you do a cost/benefit analysis if you're also going to need a car to commute back and forth to campus. Between parking, insurance, upkeep, and gas, you may not be saving all that much money by skipping the dorm option or a shared house nearby.

If you chose C, D, or E, imagine buying a house based on a picture, or moving to a city you've never been to just because a couple of your friends live there. You'd never do that. Understand the enormous commitment before you take it on, or delay enrollment until you're sure you can handle the academic responsibility and the financial burden.

3. In order to afford college, you've financially prepared yourself by:

- a) thanking your parents for setting aside a lot of their own hard-earned money in the form of a healthy college fund that you can now tap into.
- b) getting your grades high enough to qualify for every scholarship and award there is, eliminating some of the financial burden on your parents.
- c) diligently filling out loan applications from banks willing to finance your entire education.
- d) working part-time all year round at that mall, or weekends at that restaurant, just to pay your own way.